

Sweet Poison

November 14 is World Diabetes Awareness Day. And the biggest fuzzy zone in this battle revolves round insulin therapy, say doctors. Check out the common myths around insulin:

Myth: Taking insulin means I have failed oral anti-diabetic treatment and my diabetes is getting worse.

Fact: Diabetes gets harder to manage over time. Insulin is added to the treatment only to help the body replace what it isn't making naturally to help control blood sugar.

Myth: Insulin should be the last option for treating diabetes.

MANPREET ROMANA



Fact: Not really. The guide should be the HbA1c level (or blood glucose). Using insulin to regulate this doesn't make it a last resort.

Myth: Being on insulin means altering your lifestyle.

Fact: Do a reality check. Most patients wouldn't agree.

Myth: Taking insulin is painful and complicated.

Fact: No. Easy-to-use insulin pens make it very convenient and nearly painless with ultra-thin needles.

Myth: Insulin leads to weight gain.

Fact: Insulin turns calories into energy. Even if some lost calories are absorbed by the body, the benefits far outweigh the risk of weight gain.

WELLNESS WOES AT WORKPLACE

Wellness is increasingly becoming **part** of the corporate agenda worldwide. But few have taken the matter **seriously** at key strategic or operational levels. How the top 500 Indian firms **stack up** on corporate social responsibility:

GETTY IMAGES



source: Assocham 2009; Apollo Hospital Survey, 2009

42% of corporates in India do not offer any wellness programme to their employees.

30% of employees are afflicted with lifestyle disorders—obesity, diabetes, cardio-vascular ailments etc.

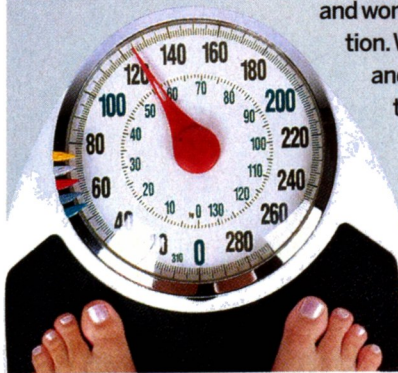
77% of employees are prone to stress over mismatched income and aspiration levels.

41% spend upto Rs 5,000 on healthcare each year, thanks to inadequate health schemes at work.

Corporate wellness programmes would help reduce chronic and lifestyle diseases in the ranks of India Inc and add up to Rs 17,000 crore to the national income by 2010, reports industry body Assocham.

Obesity Can Kill Your Sex Life

Here's another reason to fight the flab: obesity works against your libido. The biology of attraction, report Australian researchers, rests on shapes and sizes men and women have acquired over the course of evolution. When men see women with a small waistline and broad hips, they are primed to respond to those shapes, while women are attracted to the triangular shape in men. These body types are indicative of hormonal and physiological characteristics that are "naturally attractive". With a round body shape, all those cues of mating get lost.



■ Compiled by **Damayanti Datta**